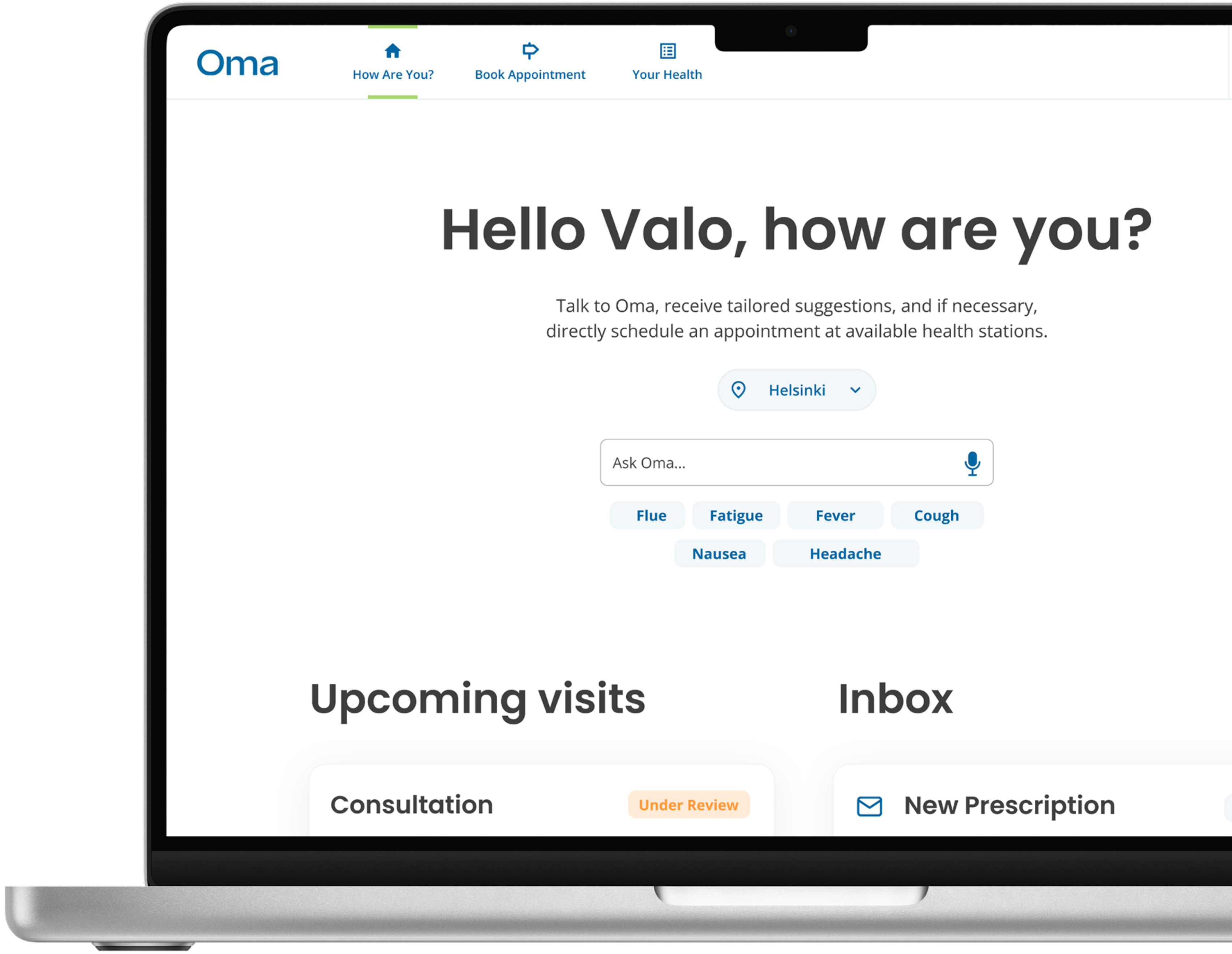
SOSIAALI- JA
TERVEYSMINISTERIÖ

Oma Healthcare

Oma is a service platform concept designed to simplify access to Finland’s public primary healthcare, developed as part of the international Student Service Design Challenge.

The project explores how systemic fragmentation, digital complexity, and lack of continuity of care impact healthcare accessibility, and how service design and emerging technologies can be used to rebuild trust, clarity, and human-centered care within public systems.

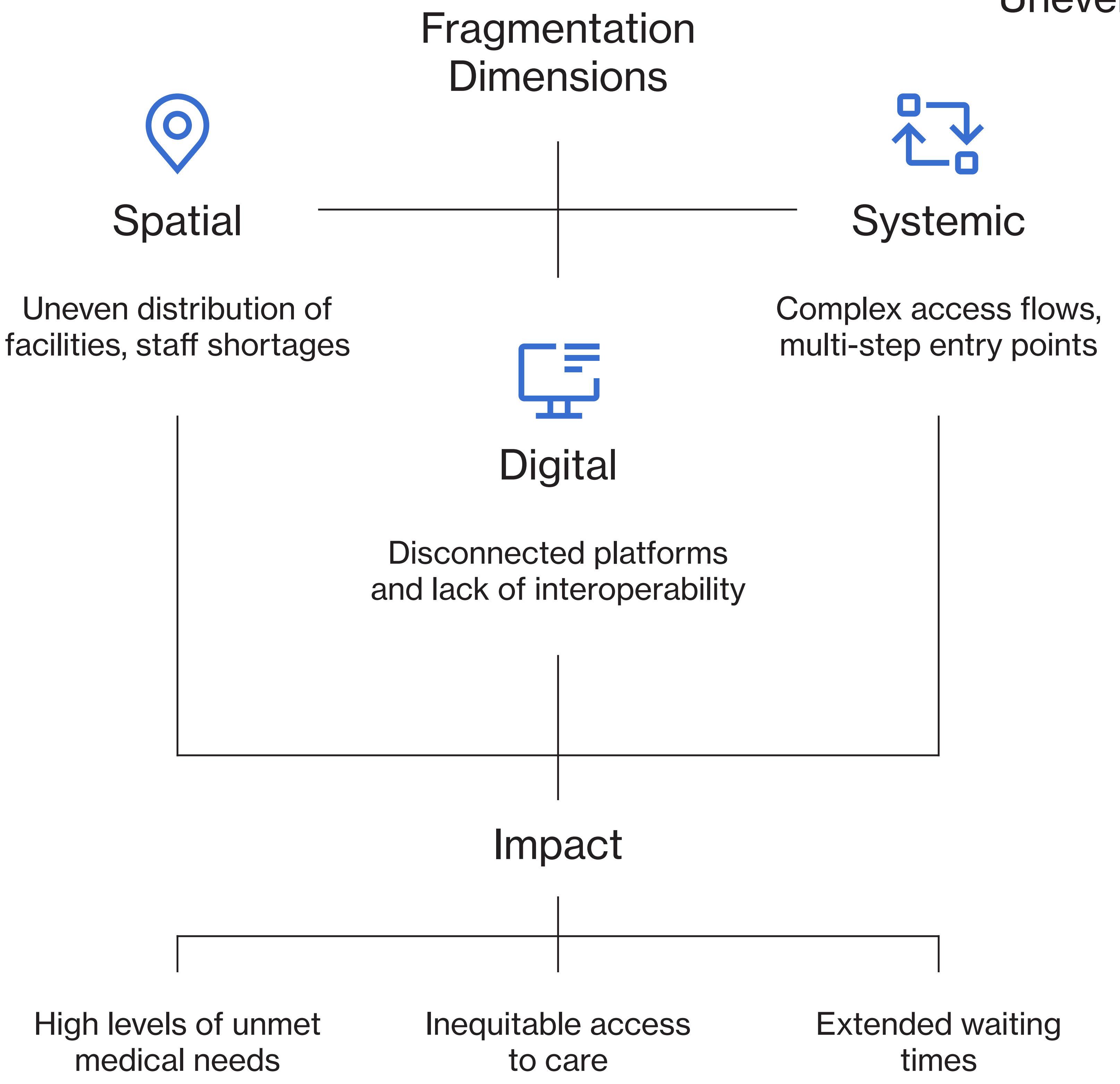


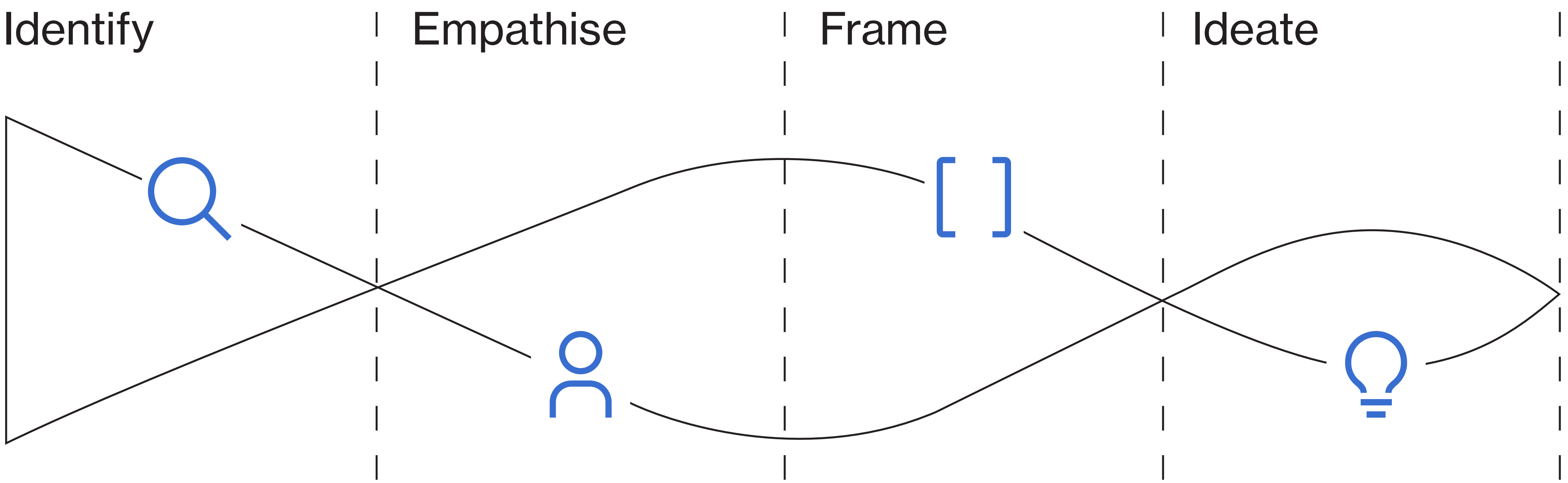
Uneven access

Finland is often recognized for having one of the most advanced healthcare systems in Europe. Yet, behind this perception lies a deeply fragmented public primary healthcare system.

Structural reforms, regional digital platforms, staff shortages, and the separation between public, private, and occupational health-care have created a system that is diffi-cult to access, especially for those without alternatives.

Approximately 4% of the population experi-ences unmet medical needs, placing Finland among the highest in Europe. Waiting times, uncertainty, and digital fragmentation dispro-portionately affect vulnerable groups.





How might we use digital services to improve accessibility, continuity, and trust in the Finnish public primary healthcare system?

Design Process

The project followed an iterative service design process combining systemic analysis and human-centered research.

We first explored and mapped the Finnish public primary healthcare system through desk research on policies, reforms, access flows, and digital infrastructures.

Then, we identified painpoints through empathy-driven research, integrating medical perspectives with qualitative insights from patients own experiences.

These insights informed a framing phase, where key challenges and opportunity areas were synthesized.

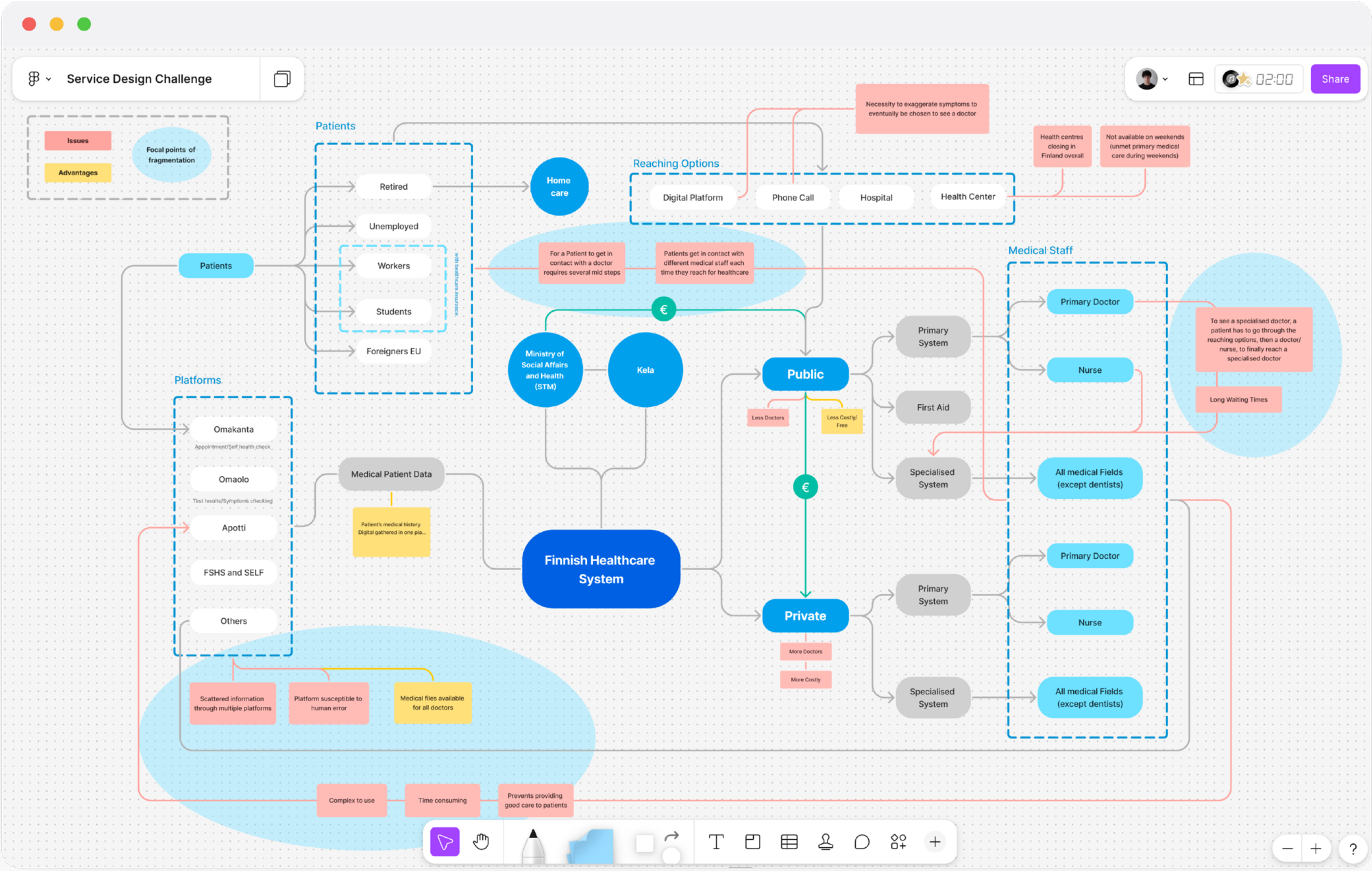
Finally, we moved into ideation, translating research into a service concept, system architecture, and service blueprint.

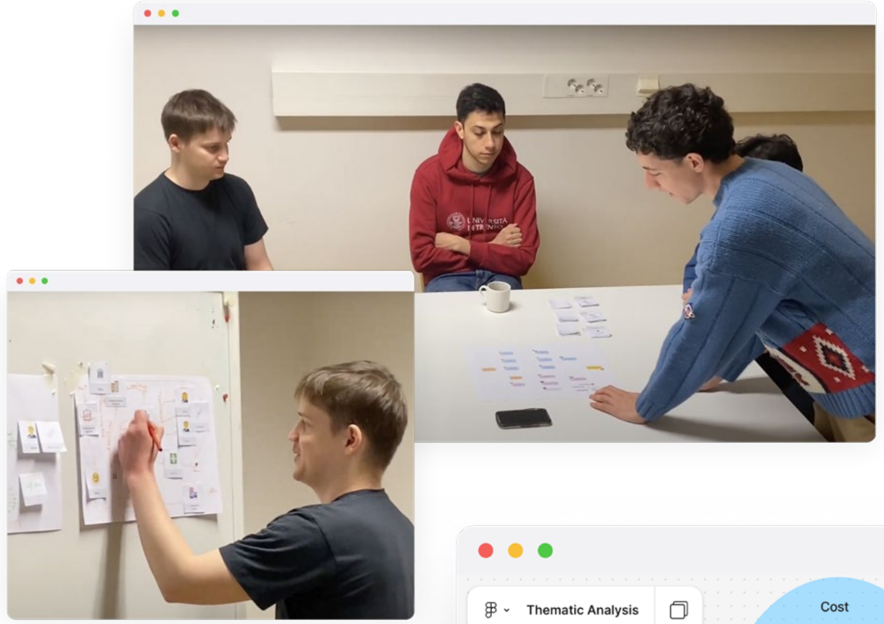
Mapping complexity to reveal leverage points

To make sense of the complexity, we mapped the system based on our desk research, visualizing relationships between public healthcare providers, occupational healthcare, private services, governmental institutions, and patients.

This systemic view revealed how individuals fall through the cracks especially when occupational healthcare ends, becoming dependent on fragmented public primary services with limited continuity.

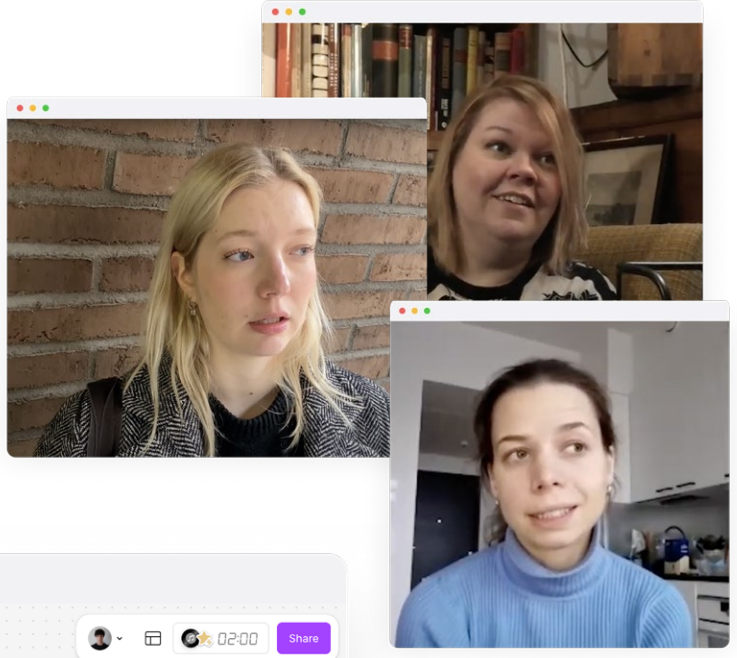
Mapping the primary public healthcare ecosystem helped us identify where intervention could generate the greatest impact without adding further complexity to an already strained system.



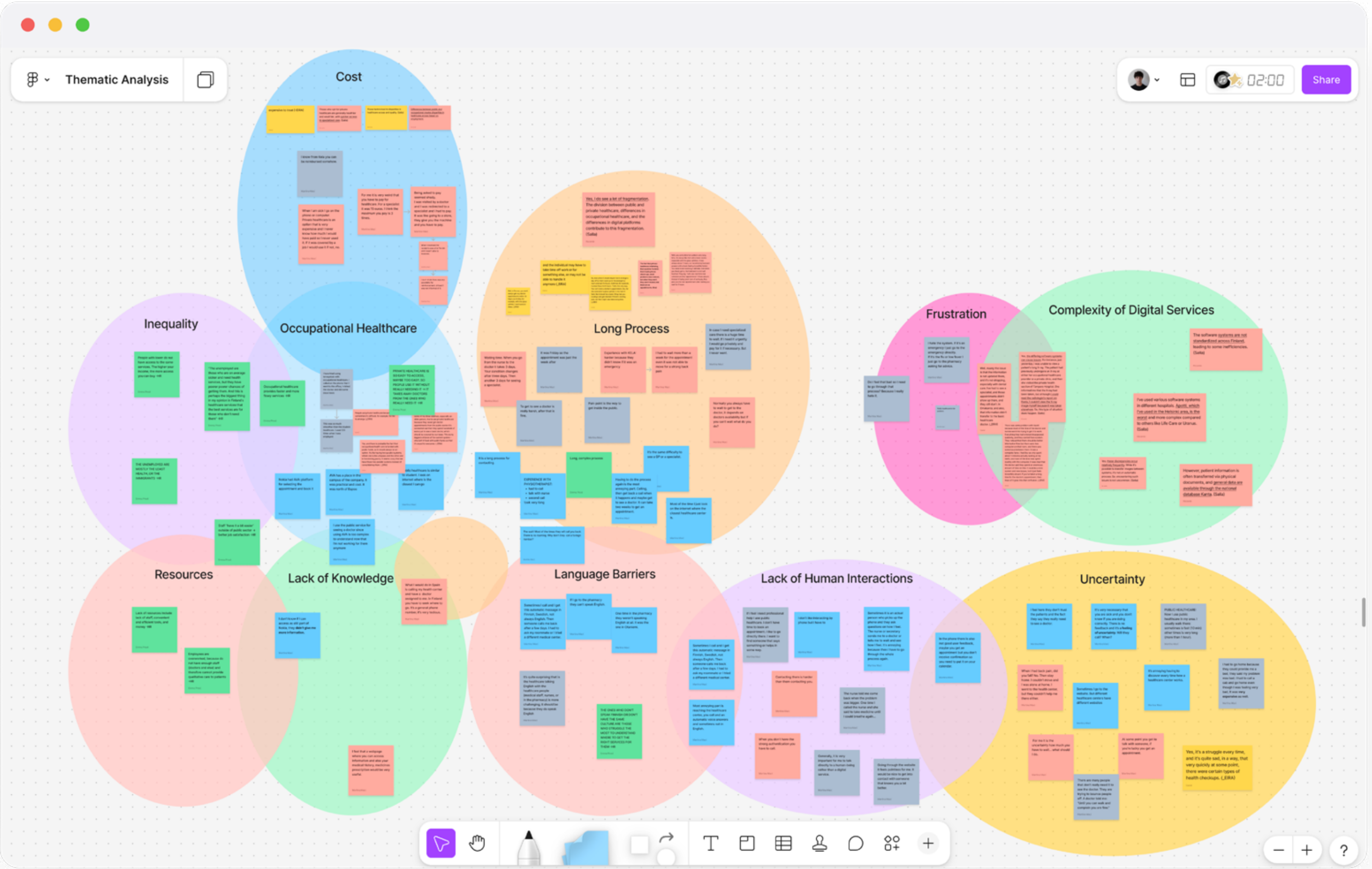


Participatory Workshop

Qualitative Research



Stakeholder Interviews



Thematic Analysis

We conducted qualitative interviews to understand healthcare access from a dual perspective: medical staff, to uncover institutional constraints and decision-making logic, and patients, to capture lived experiences of navigating the system.

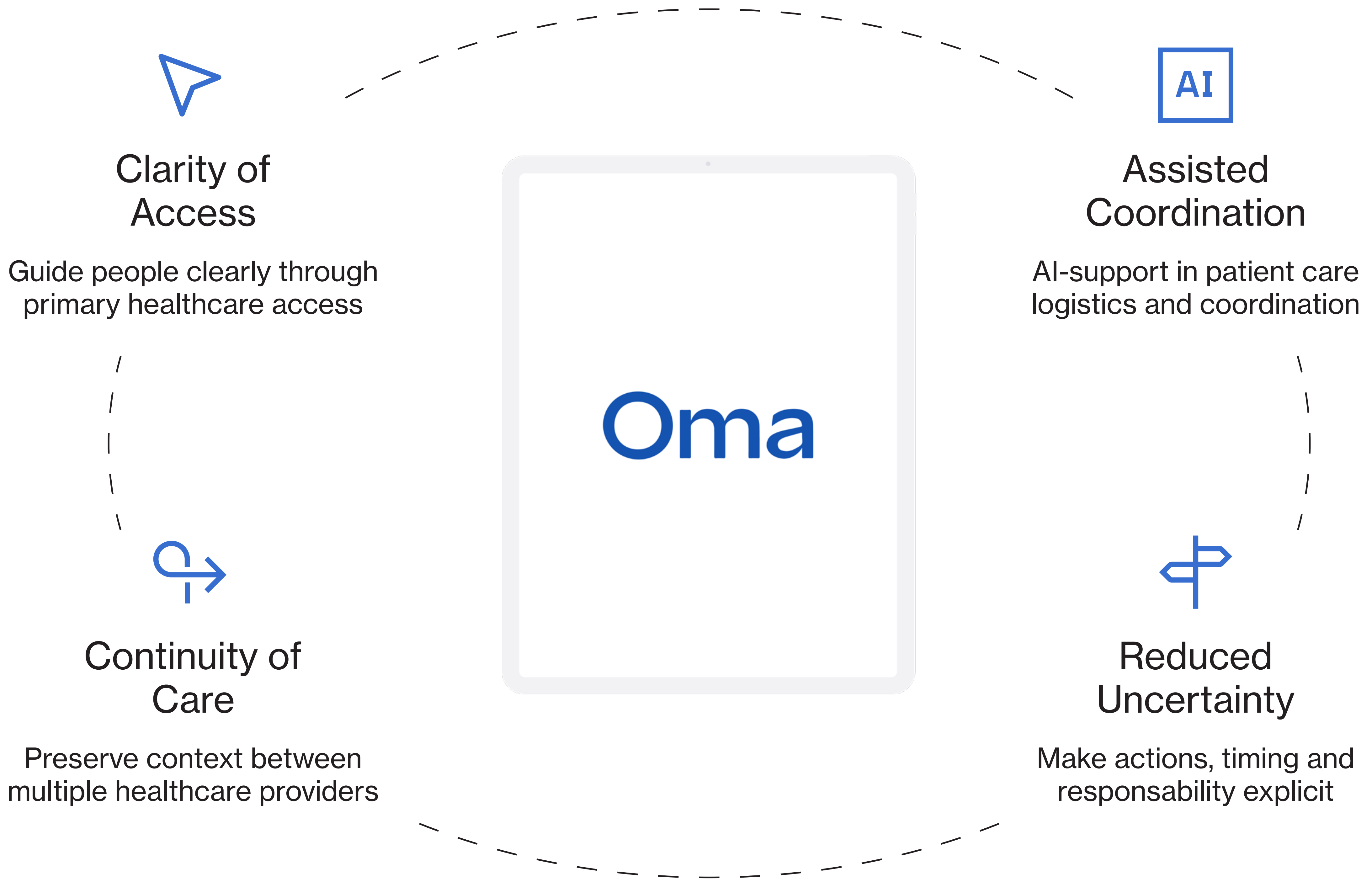
To deepen this understanding, we ran a participatory workshop focused on mapping non-occupational healthcare journeys, allowing participants to externalize touchpoints, emotions, and breakdowns across the access process.

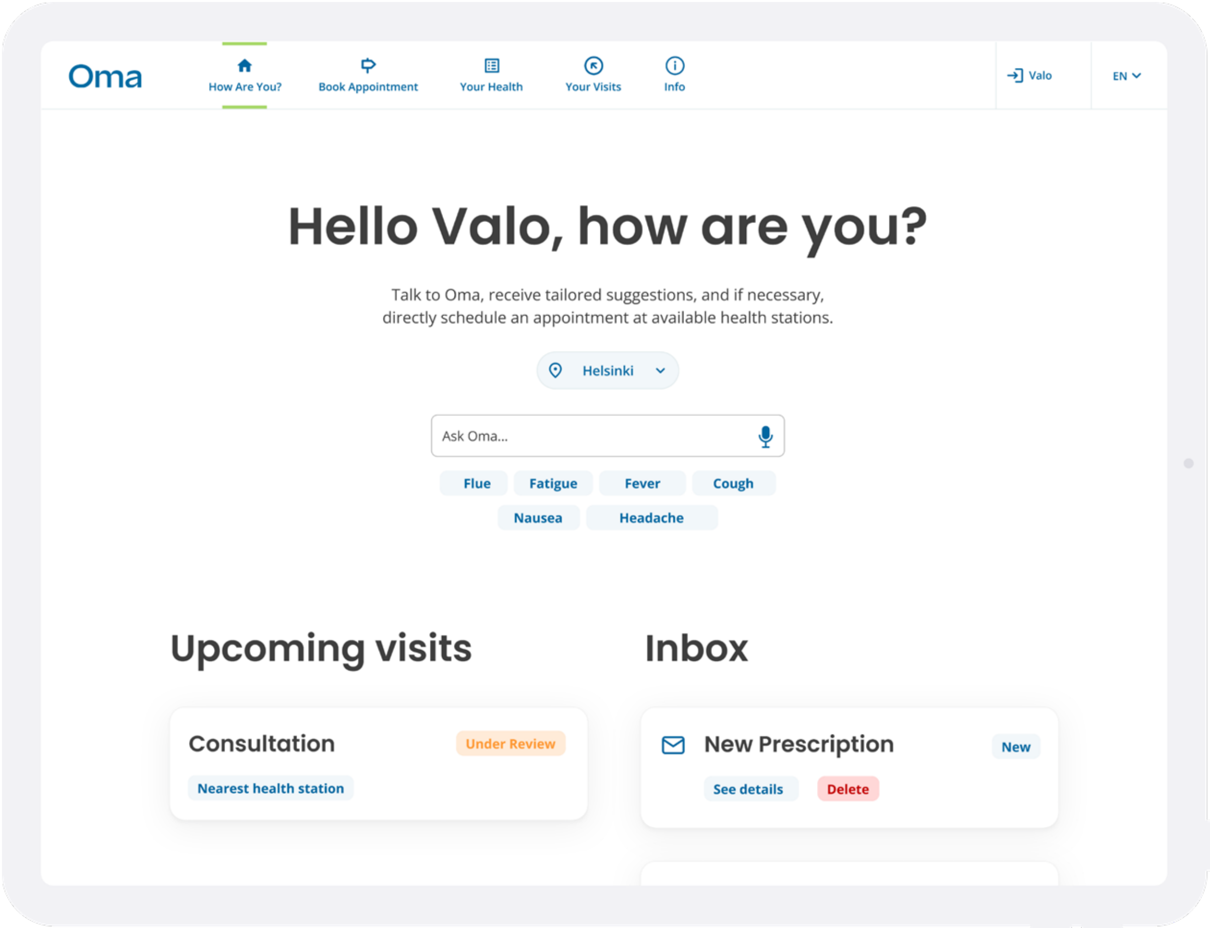
Thematic analysis of interviews and workshop outcomes validated recurring issues: fragmented access, long waiting times, lack of continuity, and a strong sense of uncertainty.

Based on system analysis and human research, Oma is conceived as a service that reframes access to public primary healthcare as a guided and continuous primary health-care experience, rather than a fragmented sequence of steps.

Instead of introducing a new parallel system, Oma acts as a service layer on top of existing healthcare infrastructures, coor-dinating information, interac-tions, and responsibilities across actors.

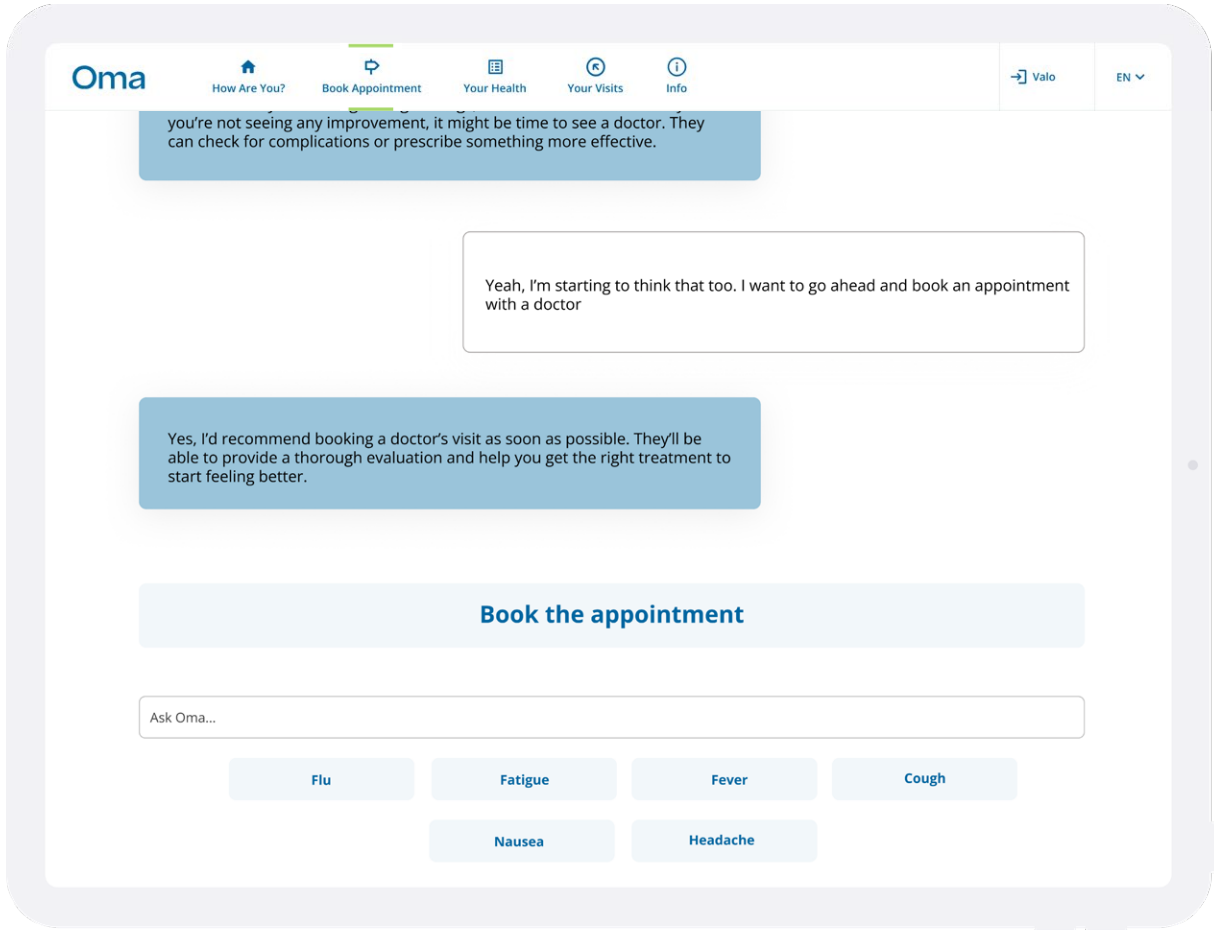
The service is designed to reduce uncertainty, support continuity of care, and preserve human decision-making, lever-aging AI tools to facilitate clinical and administrative processes.





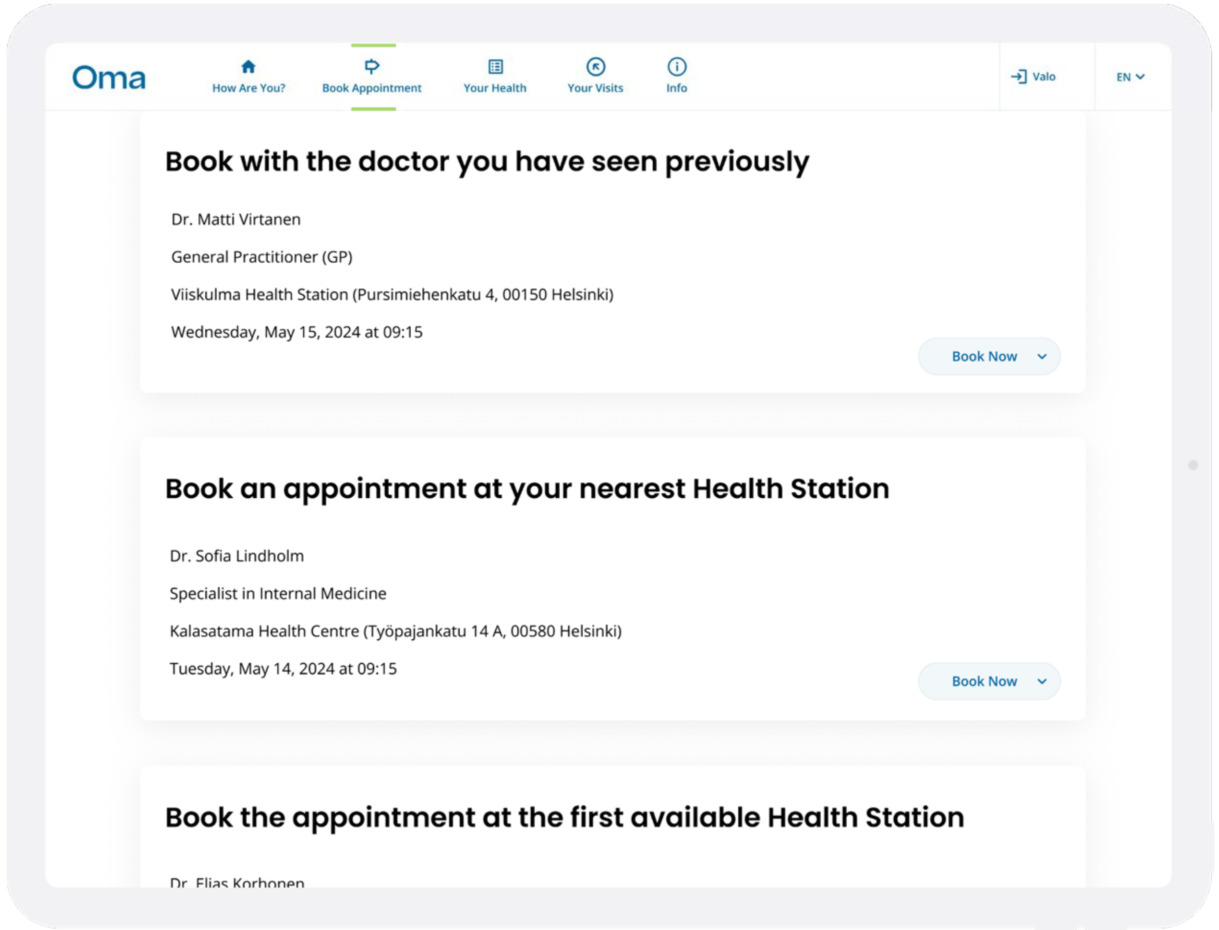
Dashboard

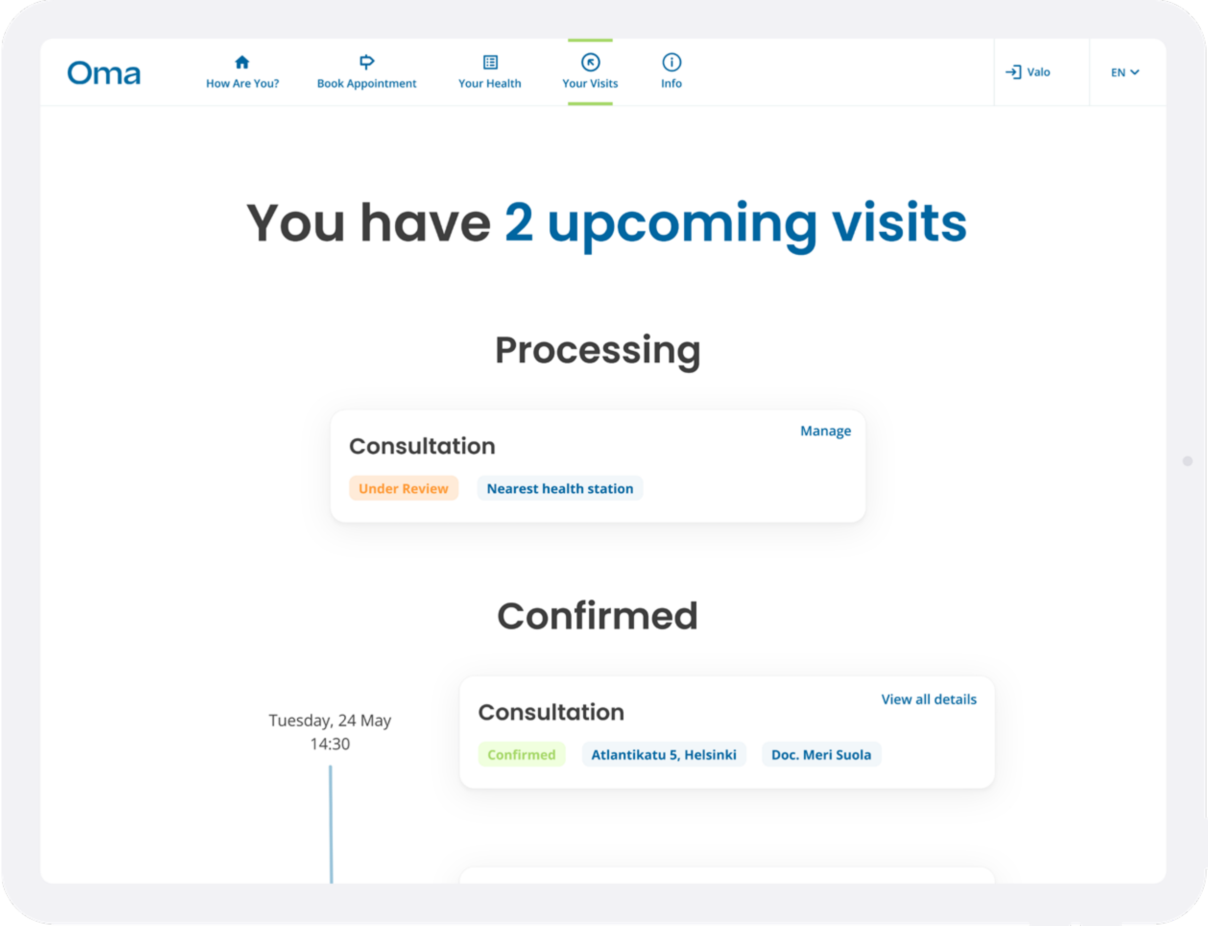
Provides a clear overview of ongoing communications and upcoming appointments, while offering quick access to symptom assessment from a single entry point.



Guided Assessment

Enables structured symptom assessment via an LLM-assisted chat, with all cases reviewed by healthcare professionals to ensure users are directed to appropriate care efficiently.



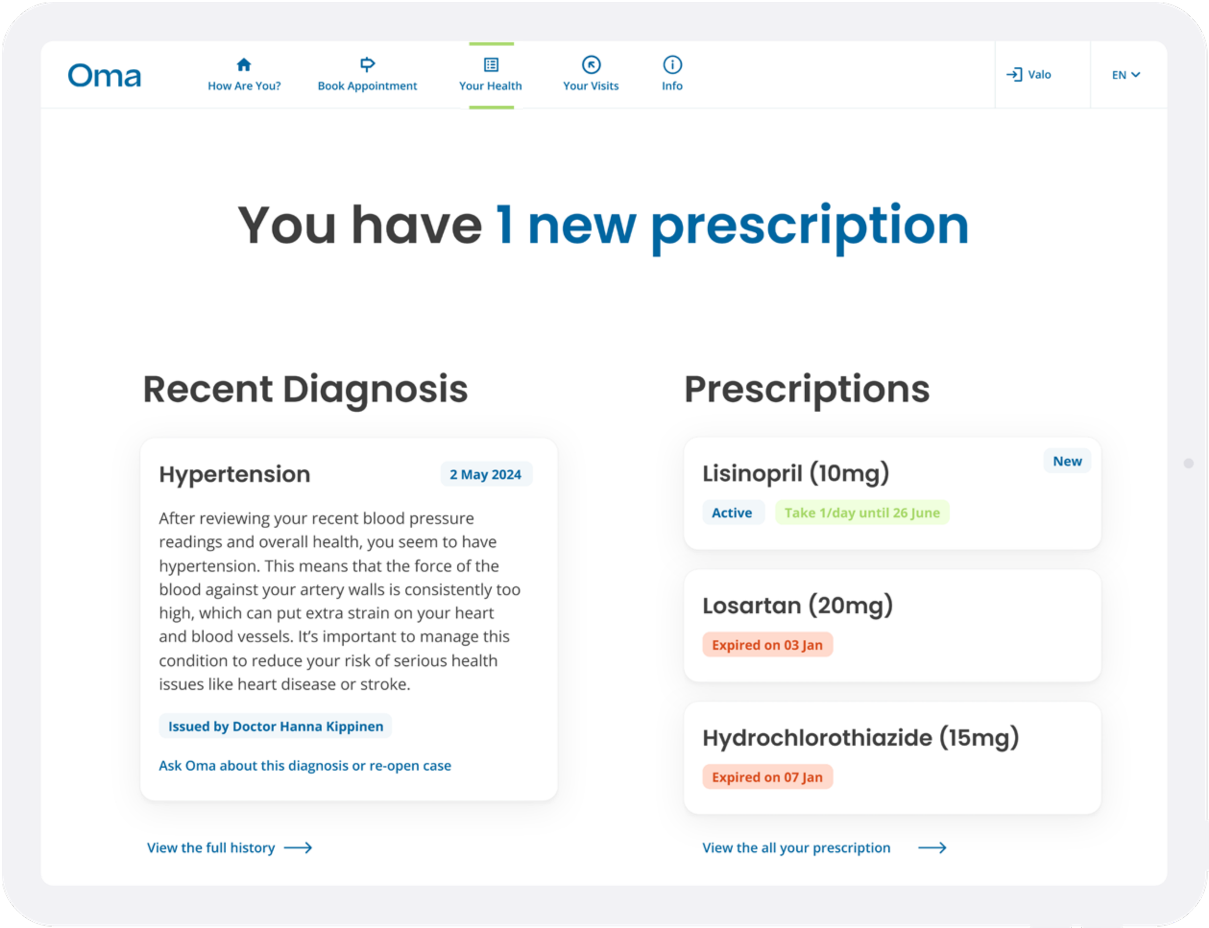


Booking Preferences

The platform allows users to choose how to book appointments by selecting between a previously seen doctor, the nearest health station, or the first available option.

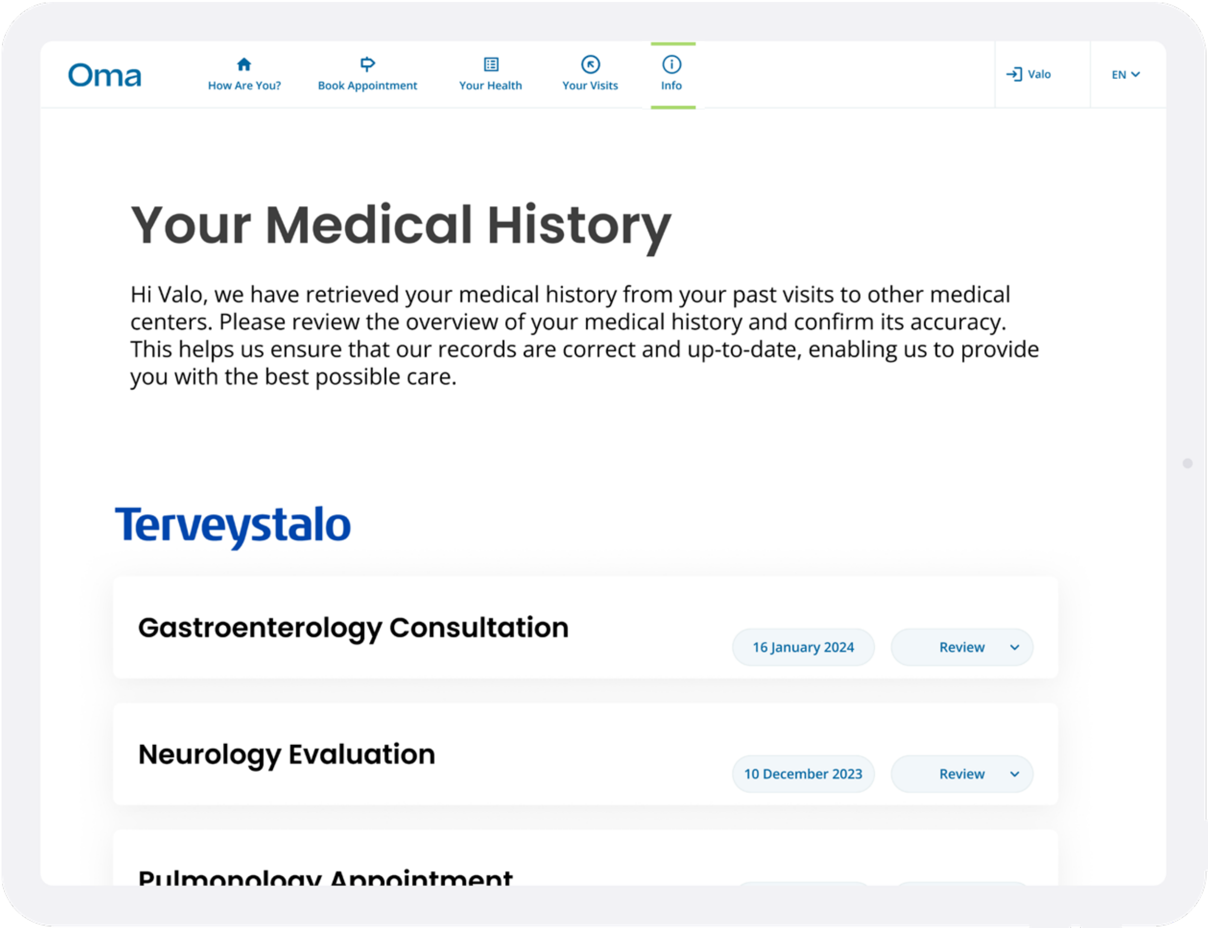
Appointment Management

Provides a unified timeline of past, ongoing, and upcoming appointments, giving users clear visibility over their care and tools to manage, reschedule, and review visit details in one place.



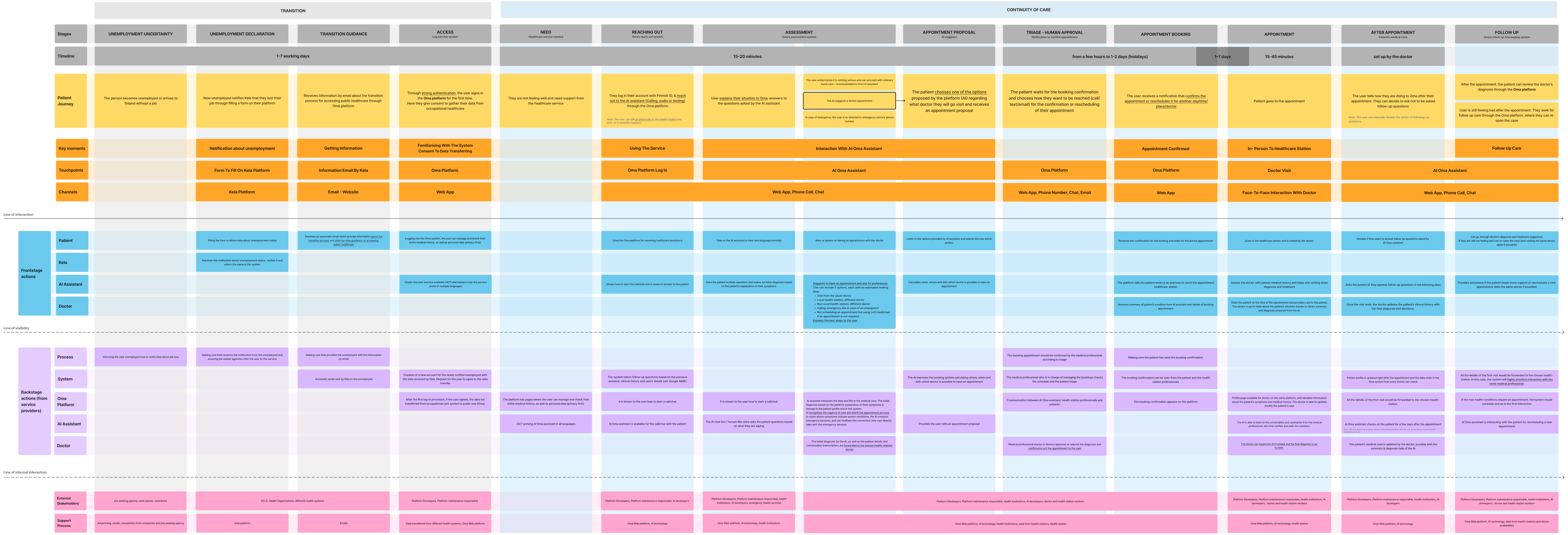
Health Overview

Keeps diagnoses, appointments, and follow-up information in one place, ensuring clarity and continuity throughout the healthcare journey for both patients and healthcare professionals.



Shared Records

Aggregates medical records from existing healthcare providers into a single and up-to-date view, enabling continuity of care and reducing fragmentation across systems.



Service Blueprint

Developing the service blueprint consolidated the Oma concept into a coherent operational model, suggesting how front-stage interactions and backstage processes could align across the healthcare journey.

Overall, the project illustrates how a carefully designed service can balance human-centered care with operational feasibility, supporting continuity and efficiency within existing institutional constraints.